Prompt Log

Name: Konathala Chaitanya
Team: Zero Trace
Role: Assessment Coordinator
Total Prompts: 10

Summary Statistics

Tools	Count	Excellent	Good	Needed Work
ChatGPT	4	3	1	0
Perplexity	2	2	0	0
Claude	3	2	1	0
Gemini	1	1	0	0

Prompt 1

Date: 2 Feb
AI Tool: ChatGPT

Purpose: I needed to understand what the IIT project requirements actually wanted from us, because the assignment guidelines had a lot of sections and I wasn't sure if we were covering everything properly.

The Prompt I Used: You are an assessment coordinator reviewing a cybersecurity threat intelligence project. Help me create a checklist to verify if a report meets assignment criteria covering Executive Summary, Threat Overview, Attack Lifecycle, Detection Methods, Mitigation, and AI Reflection sections.

Response Summary: It gave me a detailed checklist breaking down each section with specific things to look for, like whether the executive summary has clear recommendations, if the threat

overview includes real case studies, and if mitigation has prioritized controls. Made it much easier to track what was missing.

Quality Assessment

Rating: Excellent

Why: The checklist was thorough and directly matched our assignment requirements, so I could use it right away.

How I Used This

Project Section: Quality Assurance & Requirement Verification

Specific Use: Created a master checklist that I used to review each section as team members completed them.

Verification

How Verified: Cross-checked against the actual IIT project guidelines document.

Accuracy: Yes

Prompt 2

Date: 4 Feb
AI Tool: Perplexity

Purpose: I wanted to make sure our threat overview section had enough depth and wasn't just surface-level information, so I needed to understand what makes a good threat analysis.

The Prompt I Used: What are the key elements that make a cybersecurity threat analysis comprehensive and credible? Include what evaluators look for in academic or professional threat intelligence reports.

Response Summary: Explained that good threat analysis needs clear definitions, real-world examples with data, technical process explanations, sector-specific impacts, and proper citations. It also

mentioned that reports should show both breadth and depth rather than just listing facts.

Quality Assessment

Rating: Excellent

Why: Gave me clear criteria to evaluate whether our content was actually meeting professional standards.

How I Used This

Project Section: Content Quality Review

Specific Use: Used these criteria to review Indrajit's threat overview and give feedback on areas that needed more depth.

Verification

How Verified: Compared our sections against IBM and Verizon threat reports that were cited.

Accuracy: Yes

Prompt 3

Date: 5 Feb
AI Tool: Claude

Purpose: I noticed some inconsistencies in how different sections were formatted and I wasn't sure if that would affect our grade, so I needed guidance on report structure.

The Prompt I Used: You are reviewing a technical cybersecurity report for consistency. What are common formatting and structural issues that reduce report quality? Include guidance on section transitions, citation styles, and visual elements.

Response Summary: It pointed out things like inconsistent heading styles, missing transitions between sections, citation format mismatches, and poor table formatting. Also mentioned that visual

elements should have captions and be referenced in text, which we hadn't done initially.

Quality Assessment

Rating: Excellent

Why: Identified specific issues we could fix rather than just saying "make it look better."

How I Used This

Project Section: Formatting & Consistency Review

Specific Use: Created a formatting guide for the team and reviewed the entire document to fix inconsistencies.

Verification

How Verified: Checked that all sections followed the same style and citations were consistent.

Accuracy: Yes

Prompt 4

Date: 7 Feb
AI Tool: ChatGPT

Purpose: I was worried that some of our content might be too technical or too simple, and I needed to find the right balance for an academic audience.

The Prompt I Used: How do you assess whether technical content in a cybersecurity report is appropriate for an academic evaluation? Include how to balance technical depth with readability for reviewers who may not be cybersecurity experts.

Response Summary: Explained that good technical writing explains concepts clearly first, then adds technical details, and always provides context. It said to assume the reader is intelligent but not

necessarily a specialist, so define terms and explain why things matter rather than just what they are.

Quality Assessment

Rating: Good

Why: Useful guidance but I had to interpret how to apply it to our specific sections.

How I Used This

Project Section: Content Readability Assessment

Specific Use: Reviewed sections and asked team members to add explanations where technical terms appeared without context.

Verification

How Verified: Had a non-technical friend read parts and tell me if they understood the main points.

Accuracy: Yes

Prompt 5

Date: 9 Feb
AI Tool: Claude

Purpose: I needed to verify that our AI reflection section actually met the requirements, because it seemed like everyone was just writing generic things about using ChatGPT.

The Prompt I Used: What should a meaningful AI usage reflection include in an academic project report? How do you evaluate whether students genuinely reflected on AI tools versus just adding it to meet requirements?

Response Summary: Said that genuine reflection shows specific examples of prompts used, acknowledges both strengths and limitations honestly, explains how AI outputs were verified, and

demonstrates learning from the experience. Generic statements like "AI was helpful" don't count as real reflection.

Quality Assessment

Rating: Excellent

Why: Gave me clear distinction between surface-level and meaningful reflection.

How I Used This

Project Section: AI Reflection Quality Review

Specific Use: Asked team members to revise their AI reflection sections with specific examples and honest assessments.

Verification

How Verified: Checked that each person included actual prompts and specific use cases.

Accuracy: Yes

Prompt 6

Date: 10 Feb
AI Tool: Gemini

Purpose: I wanted to make sure our citations were done properly because different sections had different citation styles and I wasn't sure which one was correct.

The Prompt I Used: Explain APA, MLA, and IEEE citation formats for cybersecurity and technical reports. Which format is most commonly used in academic threat intelligence reports and why?

Response Summary: Explained that APA is most common for cybersecurity and IT security reports because it's the standard for social sciences and technology fields. Showed examples of how to cite different source types like industry reports, websites, and academic

papers. Also mentioned that consistency matters more than which style you choose.

Quality Assessment

Rating: Excellent

Why: Clarified which format we should use and gave clear examples.

How I Used This

Project Section: Citation Verification

Specific Use: Standardized all citations to APA format and created a reference list following proper format.

Verification

How Verified: Used Purdue OWL APA guide to double-check citation formats.

Accuracy: Yes

Prompt 7

Date: 12 Feb
AI Tool: Perplexity

Purpose: I needed to evaluate whether our case studies were substantial enough or if we needed more detail about the incidents we referenced.

The Prompt I Used: What makes a good case study in a cybersecurity threat report? How much detail should be included about real incidents like MOVEit breach or MGM attack to make the analysis valuable?

Response Summary: Said that good case studies include the incident timeline, specific impact with numbers, what went wrong technically, and lessons learned. Emphasized that copying facts isn't analysis - you need to explain why the incident matters for understanding the threat and what could have prevented it.

Quality Assessment

Rating: Excellent

Why: Helped me distinguish between just describing an incident versus actually analyzing it.

How I Used This

Project Section: Case Study Quality Assessment

Specific Use: Reviewed our case studies and ensured each one had impact numbers and clear lessons learned.

Verification

How Verified: Compared against original breach reports to ensure accuracy of details.

Accuracy: Yes

Prompt 8

Date: 14 Feb
AI Tool: Claude

Purpose: I was checking if our mitigation section was practical or just theoretical, because I wanted to make sure recommendations were actually implementable.

The Prompt I Used: How do you evaluate whether cybersecurity mitigation recommendations in a report are realistic and practical versus just theoretical best practices? Include criteria for assessing priority and feasibility.

Response Summary: Explained that good mitigation recommendations consider cost, implementation difficulty, and organizational context. Said to look for whether recommendations are prioritized, have clear rationale, and acknowledge resource constraints. Purely theoretical recommendations that ignore real-world limitations aren't useful.

Quality Assessment

Rating: Good

Why: Useful framework but required me to make judgment calls about what counted as practical.

How I Used This

Project Section: Mitigation Section Review

Specific Use: Verified that our mitigation recommendations included priority levels and cost considerations.

Verification

How Verified: Checked that each recommendation had clear justification and priority ranking.

Accuracy: Yes

Prompt 9

Date: 17 Feb
AI Tool: ChatGPT

Purpose: As we got closer to submission, I wanted to do a final completeness check to make sure we hadn't missed any required components.

The Prompt I Used: Create a final submission checklist for a comprehensive cybersecurity threat intelligence report including all common requirements like executive summary, methodology, analysis sections, citations, visuals, and reflection components.

Response Summary: Provided a comprehensive checklist covering content completeness, formatting consistency, citation accuracy, visual element quality, technical accuracy, and proper reflection. Also included things I hadn't thought about like page numbering, table of contents, and proper file naming.

Quality Assessment

Rating: Excellent

Why: Caught several small things we would have missed otherwise.

How I Used This

Project Section: Final Submission Review

Specific Use: Used checklist to do a complete final review before submission.

Verification

How Verified: Went through each checklist item systematically and confirmed completion.

Accuracy: Yes

Prompt 10

Date: 19 Feb
AI Tool: ChatGPT

Purpose: I wanted to understand what common mistakes students make in technical reports so I could check if we were making any of those errors.

The Prompt I Used: What are the most common mistakes students make in cybersecurity project reports that lose marks during evaluation? Include both content and presentation issues that evaluators frequently comment on.

Response Summary: Listed common issues like unsupported claims without citations, inconsistent terminology, missing transitions between sections, poor visual quality, generic conclusions that don't tie back to analysis, and AI-generated content that wasn't properly verified or integrated. Also mentioned that many students forget to explain why findings matter.

Quality Assessment

Rating: Excellent

Why: Directly addressed evaluation criteria and helped avoid common pitfalls.

How I Used This

Project Section: Error Prevention & Quality Control

Specific Use: Created a "mistakes to avoid" checklist and reviewed our report against it.

Verification

How Verified: Systematically checked for each mentioned issue and corrected problems found.

Accuracy: Yes

MY BEST PROMPTS

Most Effective: Prompt 1 — The requirement checklist became my main tool for tracking progress and ensuring we met all criteria throughout the project.

Most Improved: Prompt 5 — Had to refine this several times to understand what genuine AI reflection actually looks like versus surface-level mentions.

Lessons Learned

What Worked

Using AI as an assessment coordinator really helped me develop an eye for quality and completeness that I didn't have before. Since I was responsible for making sure our project met requirements, having AI help me create evaluation frameworks and checklists gave me structure to work with. The most valuable thing was learning to ask

specific questions about what makes content good versus just acceptable.

I found that when I asked AI to explain evaluation criteria or what reviewers look for, the responses helped me think like an evaluator rather than just a student trying to finish an assignment. This perspective shift made me much better at catching issues before they became problems. AI also helped me understand citation formats, consistency requirements, and quality standards that I honestly wouldn't have known to check otherwise.

Creating checklists and evaluation frameworks with AI's help meant I could give the team specific, actionable feedback instead of vague comments like "this section needs work." People appreciated knowing exactly what to fix or improve, which made my job easier too.

What Didn't Work

Sometimes AI gave me evaluation criteria that were too strict or didn't really apply to our student project context. For example, it would suggest things appropriate for professional threat intelligence reports that didn't make sense for a 3-week academic assignment. I had to use judgment to figure out what actually mattered for our grade versus what was nice to have.

There were also moments when I got conflicting advice from different AI tools about what should be prioritized, which was confusing. Like one tool would say detailed technical explanations are most important, while another emphasized readability and accessibility. I realized I needed to go back to the actual assignment guidelines to settle these conflicts rather than just trusting AI completely.

Another challenge was that AI couldn't really tell me if our specific content was good enough - it could give me criteria to evaluate against, but I still had to make the judgment call about whether we met those standards. Sometimes I second-guessed myself and wasn't sure if my assessment was too harsh or too lenient. I learned that checking examples from industry reports and academic papers helped calibrate my judgment better than just relying on AI descriptions of quality.

Overall, AI was incredibly helpful for building evaluation frameworks and understanding requirements, but the actual assessment still required me to develop judgment and make decisions based on our specific situation.